DO YOU KNOW?

Even today in the villages of Nilgiris district in Tamil Nadu, people have the habit of making fire without use of match box.

At first, humans were afraid of fire and lightning. Probably fire caused by lightning had killed many wild animals. Humans tasted the flesh of the killed animals, which was soft and tasty. This made humans aware of the effect of fire. They used flint stone to make fire and used it to protect them from predators, for cooking food and for creating light during night. Thus fire became important for man in olden times.

**HOTS**

Is there any object that can bring heat and fire other than a match box?

**Tamilini:** What next, grandma?

**Grandma:** You will be surprised to know that the next human invention was the wheel. This was the first scientific invention of humans using their brain and cognitive skills.

### Invention of the Wheel



The invention of wheel by humans is considered to be the foremost invention. When humans saw the stones rolling down from the mountains, probably they would have got the idea of making the wheel.

### Pot Making



Humans learned to make pot with clay. The invention of wheel made pot making easier, and the pots made were burnt to make it stronger. They decorated pots with lot of colours. The colour dyes were made from the extracts of roots, leaves or barks. These natural dyes were used in rock paintings.

**Grandma:** Can you identify what is in this picture?



Hunting scene in which men and women are taking part

**Tamilini:** Yeah. Some blurred tweaks are seen. Someone has drawn.

**Grandma:** No, this is our ancestor's handwork. In fact, it is the first art of humanity. Before the use of language, humans expressed their feelings through actions and also recorded it in rock paintings.



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